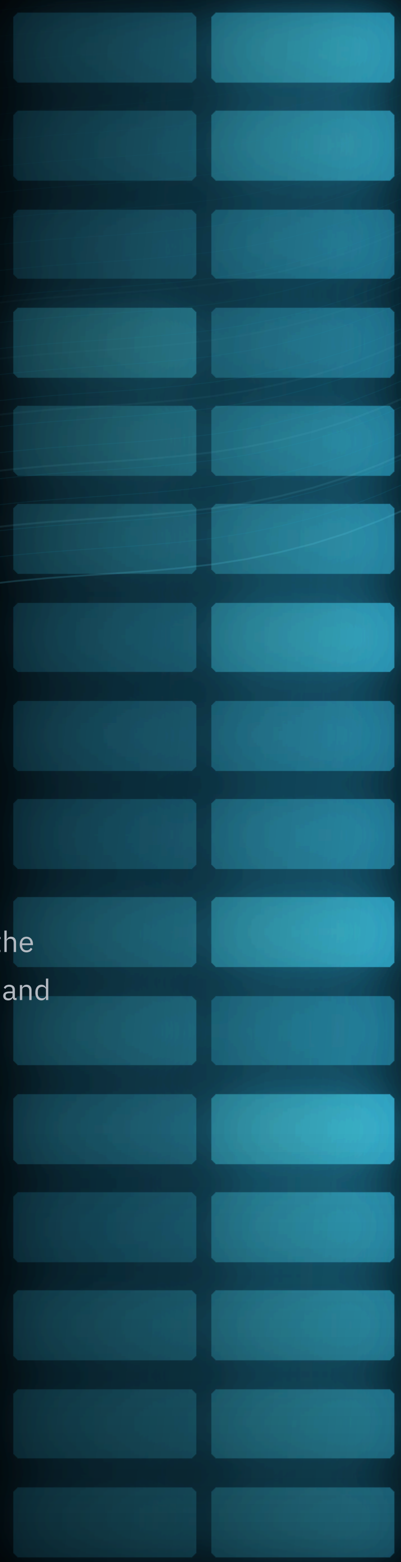
ETHER FREE RESOURCES

LESSON EIGHT

FOOTPRINT CHART BASICS



Volume at every price, inside every candle: bid and ask, the diagonal read, and imbalances. The DOM's history book, and the second half of the trigger layer.

By Sires

Ether, the free side of Ethos

Contents

This guide pairs with the video. **Watch it** for the live walkthrough, keep this next to the charts.

What the footprint is

The footprint chart is the DOM's history book. It shows the actual volume traded at each price level, broken down into aggressive buys at the ask and aggressive sells at the bid, printed inside every candle.

WHAT IT SHARES WITH THE DOM

Same raw material: aggressive orders against passive liquidity. The footprint is what the ladder looked like after the fight, price by price.

WHAT IT DOES NOT SHOW

Pace. The DOM shows the speed and rhythm of orders arriving, the footprint shows the completed result. That is why the two are read together.

6412	6664.50	6
6761	6664.25	3
8399	6664.00	12
8255	6663.75	220
4120	6663.50	410
3980	6663.25	512
2110	6663.00	77
1540	6662.75	22

Contracts exchanged at every tick, inside the candle. Bid volume prints on the left, ask volume on the right, price down the middle.

WHY TRADERS USE IT

Imbalances, absorption and high volume nodes, visible at YOUR levels, the VP ledges and shelves from Lesson 2. It is how you anticipate reversal or continuation at a level instead of guessing.

The diagonal read

The footprint prints completed orders as numbers on both sides of the candle, bid on the left, ask on the right. And you do not compare them straight across, you compare them diagonally, like a ladder.

Compare the 56 ask to the 5 bid one tick below. Diagonal, not side by side.

Buyers lifting the ask at one price fight the sellers hitting the bid one tick lower. Reading up the diagonals shows you who is winning the longs, reading down the diagonals shows you the shorts, the same contest the DOM shows live.

THE SPREAD COST NOBODY THINKS ABOUT

Every market order crosses the spread and pays for it. On NQ the aggressive side pays that cost on every single fill. Using limit orders instead of market orders saves serious money if you trade often, that idea is the core of high frequency trading.

Imbalances

An imbalance is where one aggressive side heavily outweighed the other at a price.

BUY IMBALANCE

Buyers lift the offer far more than sellers hit the bid. Demand over supply at that price, pressure pointing up.

SELL IMBALANCE

Sellers hit the bid far more than buyers lift the offer. Supply over demand, pressure pointing down.

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Flagged imbalances on the footprint (the highlighted asks). Most platforms mark them when one side is 3x to 4x larger than the diagonal opposite.

THE THRESHOLD

3x to 4x is the standard flag. Below that it is noise, above it someone was genuinely one sided at that price.

Stacked imbalances and value

A single imbalance is noise. Stack several and you have a zone the whole market will remember.

Three or more imbalances in a row build an unfinished auction, the market tends to return and finish it.

STACKED BUYING

Several buy imbalances in a column show aggressive buyers stepping up tick after tick. It marks a demand zone, price often revisits it and holds.

STACKED SELLING

Several sell imbalances stacked down show sellers hitting every bid. A supply zone, price revisits it and caps. Same idea, mirrored.

The footprint also draws its own value area and POC inside each candle or session, the same POC, VAH and VAL from the profile lessons, now at the resolution of individual prints. The candle POC is where the heaviest business traded, and it behaves like a magnet on the retest.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

Stacked imbalances and single prints are the footprint's version of poor highs and lows. They are magnets and targets, mark them and let price come back to repair them.

The footprint at your levels

The footprint earns its place at your levels, not in the middle of nowhere. The routine:

- **Bring the level**
  VP ledges and shelves, value edges, old POCs. The footprint is the microscope, the level is the slide.
- **Read the diagonals into the level**
  Who was aggressive on approach? A level hit by exhausted aggression behaves differently to one hit by fresh conviction.
- **Look for stacked imbalances**
  Two or three flagged imbalances in a row at a level is real pressure, one alone is noise.
- **Watch the high volume prices**
  Where the biggest numbers printed inside the candle is where the argument happened. Those prices matter on the retest.
- **Pair it with the DOM**
  Footprint for the history, ladder for the pace. Together they are the trigger layer of the method.

Now read the prints.

You can now see exactly who paid up at every price. Inside Ethos, the mentorship, the KG models combine the footprint with the ladder live, three sessions a week.

- **Diagonal, never side by side**
  The ask fights the bid one tick below it. That is the read.
- **3x to 4x or it is noise**
  Real imbalances are lopsided. Everything else is chatter.
- **Levels give prints meaning**
  A number without a location is trivia.

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